

Wells Fargo & Co. Interview Experiences (Internship)

About Wells Fargo & Co.

Wells Fargo is a major American financial services company headquartered in San Francisco, California. It provides banking, investment, mortgage, and consumer finance services to individuals, businesses, and institutions. Founded in 1852 during the California Gold Rush, Wells Fargo is now among the largest banks in the U.S. by assets and branch network.

The Wells Fargo logo, consisting of the words "WELLS" and "FARGO" in white, uppercase, sans-serif font, stacked vertically on a red rectangular background.

Eligibility Criteria

- 7.5 & above
- No current arrears

Selection Process

1. Pre-Placement Talk (Online)
2. Online Assessment (Offline at CUIC)
3. Technical + HR Interview (Offline at CUIC)

Preparation Overview

- Try to solve questions on Leetcode, Hackerrank, GeeksForGeeks to improve your problem-solving skills.
- I used the NeetCode-150 DSA sheet and Striver's sheet as well.
- Avoid jumping directly to solutions; try solving them on your own first. Memorizing solutions doesn't help in the long run.
- Focus on pattern-based learning. Almost all of the DSA problems will fall under a certain pattern for which solutions will need a similar approach.
- Go through common interview questions, and study DSA, OOPS, DBMS, OS, Networks, and SDLC concepts, as well as the fundamentals of at least one programming language.
- Be confident in everything you include in your resume. Always be ready to explain your projects with clarity. Never include a topic in your resume or talk about it in the interviews that you are not comfortable with. You will be asked follow-up questions as well, so have a deep understanding of whatever you include in your resume.
- Try solving aptitude questions as well.
- Don't get discouraged by failure. I failed one interview, but succeeded the next.

Online Assessment

It was conducted on the SHL platform at CUIC. It consisted of 4 sections.

Section 1: Coding (60 minutes, 1 question)

- The driver code wasn't provided. We were required to code from scratch.
- There weren't any choices for the language. We were asked to code in Java.
- The question was a medium-hard graph-based question.
- There was a different set of questions.

Question:

You are given a set of cities and the cost to reach from one city to another in a matrix (each row is a distance vector of a city). Find the minimum cost to visit every city only once and return to the start city. (-1 indicates that the city is not reachable)

Input:

Number of cities: 3

Cost matrix:

-1 10 50

50 -1 10

10 50 0

Output: 30. We can visit 0->1->2->0 and cost = 10+10+10 = 30.

Out of two test cases, my code passed one. The challenge I faced here wasn't the problem itself, but the language. Since we studied Java in our 3rd semester, it took me around 40 minutes to recall the syntax and libraries. Later, I read the document where they specified details of the internship and found that they anticipate Java as a compulsory language to be known. This taught me the importance of carefully reading company-specific guidelines before appearing for any online assessments or interviews.

Section 2: Verbal aptitude (15 minutes, 20 questions)

- Reading comprehension, detecting what is wrong with the sentence, finding the synonym/antonym, etc.
- IndiaBIX has similar questions, which you can use to practice.
- This section required basic English knowledge.

Section 3: Business aptitude (25 minutes, 14 questions)

- This section contained pie charts, bar graphs, and candlestick graphs interpretation questions.
- It also had questions on some basic Math and logic, like ratios, etc.
- IndiaBIX provides similar practice questions.

The problem I faced in this section was the time constraint. I read seniors' experiences, which guided me on what can be asked in this section. Familiarity with basic stock market and finance-related terms can also be helpful.

Section 4: Coding (45 minutes, 2 questions, free navigation)

- The questions were of easy-medium difficulty.
- Each one of us received different questions.
- The driver code was provided, and choices for the language as well.

Question 1: Find the duplicates in the array.

Question 2: Given a 1D array that represents the state of lamp posts along a street (0-off, 1-on). If the states before and after a particular lamp post are both off then the next day this lamp post will

also be turned off. Given such an array and the no of days, find the state of the lamp posts at the end.

Input:

Array: [0, 1, 1, 0, 1, 0, 0]

Days: 2

Output:

Initial: [0, 1, 1, 0, 1, 0, 0]

Day 1:

- index 0 → no left neighbor (keep as 0).
- index 1 → neighbors = (0,1) → not both 0 → stays 1.
- index 2 → neighbors = (1,0) → not both 0 → stays 1.
- index 3 → neighbors = (1,1) → not both 0 → stays 0.
- index 4 → neighbors = (0,0) → both 0 → becomes 0.
- index 5 → neighbors = (1,0) → not both 0 → stays 0.
- index 6 → no right neighbor (keep as 0).

Result after Day 1: [0, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0] Final result: [0, 1, 1, 0, 0, 0, 0]

39 students were shortlisted for the interview, and I was one among them.

Technical Interview:

- This interview round was conducted virtually through a video call at CUIC.
- I was asked to give a self-introduction.
- The interviewer asked what language I am comfortable with, and I said C++. He asked me OOPS-related questions on inheritance, polymorphism, abstract classes, overloading Vs. overriding specific to C++.
- I used SHA-256 in one of my projects, and so he asked me about it. He asked me why I used SHA-256 and asked me to explain it.
- I was asked DBMS-related questions, like the difference between relational and document-type DB. I used MongoDB in my projects, and so he asked me about its applications and why we use it. He asked me about joins and indices. He asked me in which kind of databases joins and indices are powerful.
- He asked me about Semaphore, and its use. I explained that it helps in concurrency control during race conditions and can also prevent deadlocks to some extent.
- He asked me server-side fundamentals, like API and types of API, RestAPI. I was also asked about SOAP.
- I was asked DSA questions at the end. I was asked to explain Doubly Linked List, Deque, BFS & DFS, along with their real-life applications. I was asked to explain Dijkstra's algorithm and Red-Black tree.
- I was also asked to explain one of my projects.

These are the questions I recall, though the interviewer asked several more. To crack any technical round interviews, be prepared in DSA, OOP, DBMS, OS, Computer Networks, and your resume as well.

Technical-HR interview:

- This round went about 20 minutes and was conducted in person.

- I was asked to give a self-introduction.
- The interviewer asked me questions on OOPS. He asked why the concept of OOPS was introduced, given that modularity was already achieved through procedures in Procedural Programming Languages.
- He then asked me to explain exactly how real-world mapping is done in OOPS.
- He asked me to explain all of the OOPS concepts I know.
- He asked me to explain one of my projects.
- I used MERN stack, and so he asked me to tell the difference between Node.js, Express.js, and React.js.
- He asked me about an internship I did for automation in our department.
- He asked me how I study and what strategies I use to learn a concept.
- I was given a chance to ask questions. I asked about Wells Fargo's projects, work culture, and ownership provided to the interns.
- He then started explaining how the corporate world works and work-life at Wells Fargo. He gave me some tips and advice.

HR interview:

- This round was conducted in person.
- I was asked to give a self-introduction.
- I was asked why I want to do an internship at Wells Fargo.
- I was given a chance to ask questions. I asked about the same I asked in the second round to know her perspective. We then started discussing a lot about Wells Fargo. She was very approachable and friendly. We talked about her domain in Wells Fargo and her experience working in Wells Fargo.

And finally, the result came with my name included, along with the other nine selected candidates for the intern role.

General Advice:

- Practice platforms: LeetCode, HackerRank, GeeksForGeeks, takeUForward, NeetCode, IndiaBIX
- <https://neetcode.io/practice?tab=neetcode150>
- C.O.D.E series conducted by ACM-CEG
- [Blind 75 - LeetCode](#)
- [MUST-DO Questions for \[DBMS, CN, OS\] Interviews: SDE Core Sheet - Tutorial](#)
- [Striver's SDE Sheet – Top Coding Interview Problems](#)

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